

## Context Analysis & Project Plan — Rubric

### Scale

All course rubrics use the same 5-point scale.

| Level | Label          |
|-------|----------------|
| 4     | Exemplary      |
| 3     | Proficient     |
| 2     | Developing     |
| 1     | Emerging       |
| 0     | Not Acceptable |

### Dimensions

Five dimensions, equally weighted at 20% each.

| Dimension                | Weight | Competency → Subskill                        | Evaluates      |
|--------------------------|--------|----------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Research Quality         | 20%    | Critical Thinking → Research & Analysis      | Part 2         |
| Evidence-Based Reasoning | 20%    | Critical Thinking → Evidence-Based Reasoning | Part 2         |
| Strategic Implications   | 20%    | Critical Thinking → Problem Framing          | Part 3         |
| Planning Quality         | 20%    | Critical Thinking → Prioritization           | Part 4         |
| Document Quality         | 20%    | Communication → Written Clarity              | Whole document |

### Dimension 1: Research Quality

*Critical Thinking → Research & Analysis Evaluates Part 2: Research Findings*

| Level                 | Descriptor                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Exemplary (4)</b>  | Findings are specific to this project context, grounded in cited sources, and presented with enough detail to be useful. Gaps in what the team doesn't yet know are named and given meaningful consideration. |
| <b>Proficient (3)</b> | Findings are broadly relevant and supported by cited sources. Gaps are acknowledged.                                                                                                                          |

|                           |                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Developing (2)</b>     | Findings are present but generic — applicable to almost any project in this space. Sources are thin or uncited. Gaps are not acknowledged.             |
| <b>Emerging (1)</b>       | Findings are vague or largely restate what would be known without investigation. Sources are absent or insufficient to support the findings presented. |
| <b>Not Acceptable (0)</b> | No meaningful research is present. The section is missing or contains only information requiring no independent investigation.                         |

## Dimension 2: Evidence-Based Reasoning

*Critical Thinking → Evidence-Based Reasoning Evaluates Part 2: Research Findings — whether claims follow from evidence rather than assertion.*

| Level                     | Descriptor                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Exemplary (4)</b>      | Claims are consistently grounded in the research. The team distinguishes clearly between what the evidence shows and what they are inferring from it. Where evidence runs out, assumptions and uncertainty are named explicitly. |
| <b>Proficient (3)</b>     | Most claims are grounded in the research. The team generally distinguishes between findings and inferences, even if not always explicitly. Some uncertainty is acknowledged.                                                     |
| <b>Developing (2)</b>     | Claims are frequently asserted without grounding in the research. The team does not distinguish between what they found and what they're concluding. Uncertainty is not acknowledged.                                            |
| <b>Emerging (1)</b>       | Claims are largely unsupported assertions. There is little evidence that conclusions follow from any research base.                                                                                                              |
| <b>Not Acceptable (0)</b> | No meaningful attempt to ground claims in evidence.                                                                                                                                                                              |

## Dimension 3: Strategic Implications

*Critical Thinking → Problem Framing Evaluates Part 3: Strategic Implications*

| Level                 | Descriptor                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Exemplary (4)</b>  | Implications are clearly derived from the research and meaningfully shape the direction of the project. They are specific to this context and identify tradeoffs, tensions, or strategic choices the team must navigate. |
| <b>Proficient (3)</b> | Implications follow logically from the research and are relevant to this project context. They identify clear priorities or considerations that should shape the team's approach.                                        |
| <b>Developing (2)</b> | Implications are present but remain general or loosely connected to the                                                                                                                                                  |

|                           |                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                           | research. They resemble broad observations rather than project-specific direction.                                              |
| <b>Emerging (1)</b>       | Implications are vague, generic, or disconnected from the research findings. They do not meaningfully inform project direction. |
| <b>Not Acceptable (0)</b> | No meaningful strategic implications are articulated.                                                                           |

## Dimension 4: Planning Quality

*Critical Thinking → Prioritization Evaluates Part 4: Project Plan*

| Level                     | Descriptor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Exemplary (4)</b>      | The plan is realistic, clearly structured, and aligned with the project's strategic direction. Roles are clearly defined. Risks are thoughtfully identified with plausible mitigation strategies. Scope reflects intentional prioritization rather than breadth. |
| <b>Proficient (3)</b>     | The plan is coherent and generally aligned with the project direction. Roles are defined. Risks are identified. Scope is reasonable, though tradeoffs or scoping decisions are not made explicit.                                                                |
| <b>Developing (2)</b>     | The plan is present but lacks clarity, alignment, or realism. Roles may be unevenly defined. Risks are listed but not meaningfully considered. Scope may appear overly broad or underdeveloped.                                                                  |
| <b>Emerging (1)</b>       | The plan is vague, incomplete, or unrealistic. Roles are unclear. Risks are absent or superficial. Scope is not thoughtfully considered.                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Not Acceptable (0)</b> | No meaningful project plan is provided.                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

## Dimension 5: Document Quality

*Communication → Written Clarity Evaluates the document as a professional artifact*

| Level                 | Descriptor                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Exemplary (4)</b>  | The document is clear, well-organized, and professional. The document reads as a unified whole despite being produced by a team. Ideas flow logically across sections. Writing is concise and precise. Formatting enhances readability. |
| <b>Proficient (3)</b> | The document is organized and understandable. Writing is generally clear, though occasional awkward phrasing or minor errors may appear. Formatting supports readability.                                                               |
| <b>Developing (2)</b> | Organization is uneven or sections lack clarity. The document may read as separately written sections that were not fully integrated. Writing may be wordy, imprecise, or contain noticeable errors. Formatting inconsistencies         |

|                           |                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                           | detract from readability.                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Emerging (1)</b>       | The document is difficult to follow. Organization is unclear. Writing contains frequent errors or unclear phrasing. Formatting hinders readability. |
| <b>Not Acceptable (0)</b> | The document is incomplete or unreadable.                                                                                                           |